



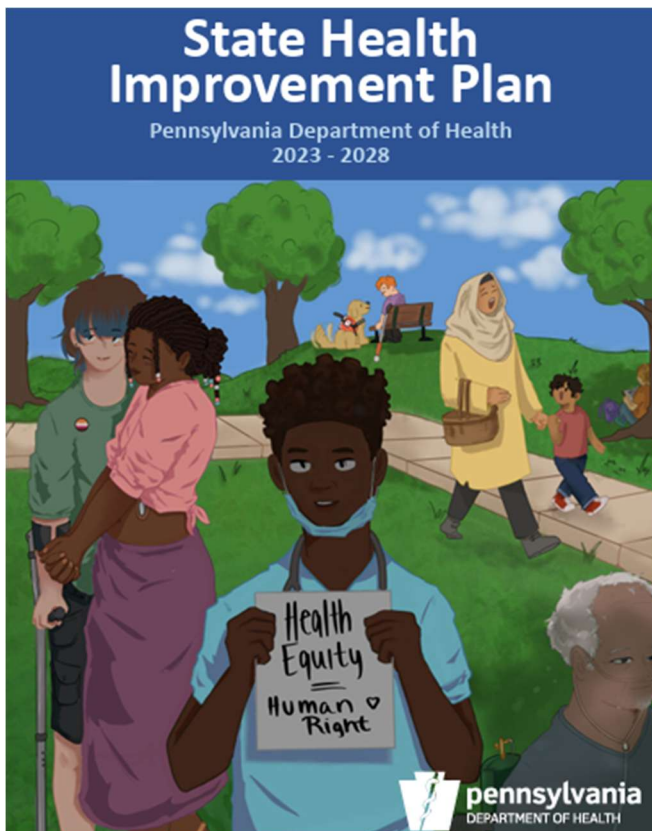
Healthy Community Lifespaces

Pennsylvania School Student contest

Creating a State Symbol – 2025/26 State Vegetable Contest

Educators, Parents and Students

This contest incorporates health and the importance of eating more fruits and vegetables into lessons in science and/or social studies to align with state standards for studying the legislative process, state symbols, or origins of plants to determine a native state fruit and vegetable. Creative displays to go with a written proposal are welcome. Multiple methods of presentations to meet various learning styles are welcome. Small groups or individual entries are welcome.



cover by PA high school student)

Health and well-being must be a priority at every level—national, state, community, and individual. National efforts such as **Healthy People 2030** emphasize that promoting health is a shared responsibility across public, private, and nonprofit sectors. States, including Pennsylvania, follow this model through their **State Health Improvement Plans (SHIPs)**. HCL is part of the task force shaping Pennsylvania's new plan to set priorities, guide resources, and develop programs and policies. Research shows that supportive communities, where health is built into policies, environments, and education, are essential to reducing disparities and improving health span for all.

Thank you for working with us to build a healthy community



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First prizes are several \$25 dollar scholarships towards the student winners to participate in a physical fitness activity of their choice.

Honorable mention - Bike helmet

HCL will facilitate the winners to talk with State legislators to pass the legislation for their chosen vegetable . A fruit is currently being considered.



Find out more

Official Rules

- Students in Grades 4- 7 can enter with parent and teacher permission.
- Contest students must submit a proposal for a vegetable to be a State symbol.

The proposal should include:

Vegetables with most the health benefits.

- Most native to Pennsylvania or that all Pennsylvanians will have access find to eat.
- Reasons why Pennsylvanians should eat this vegetable(s).
- Reasons why we should have vegetables as state symbol.

Basic contest Rubric

Feature	4	3	2	1	Score
Ideas	Strong Informative with clear focus and supporting reason for choice of fruit or vegetable	Developing Develops a focus Uses some descriptive language Details support idea Communicates original ideas	Emerging Attempts focus Ideas not fully developed	Beginning Lacks focus and development	
Organization	Establishes a strong beginning, middle, and end Demonstrates an orderly flow of ideas	Attempts an adequate introduction and ending Evidence of logical sequencing	Some evidence of a beginning, middle, and end Sequencing is attempted	Little or no organization Relies on single idea	
Expression	Uses effective language Uses high-level vocabulary Use of sentence variety	Diverse word choice Uses descriptive words Sentence variety	Limited word choice Basic sentence structure/speech	No sense of sentence structure/ in speech if presented as video	



Healthy Community Lifespaces

Email entry with Parent permission and information below to:

- Healthy Community Lifespaces at Healthycommunitylifespaces@gmail.com
- Contest entries should be received by December 31, 2025

STUDENT ENTRY

Student Name:

Emails to send contest results:

Teacher

School

Grade

Parent permission:

I give permission for my student's name to be announced if your child wins, I agree to use the prize monies towards participation in a physical activity in my community and I take responsibility for any and all liability pertaining to -transportation to and from the activity should my child win the contest.

Parent signature

- Contact HCL with any questions or for lesson plan ideas

In Collaboration to make Pennsylvania a healthy environment for all children,

Dr. Marianne Infante, M.Ed., OTD
healthycommunitylifespaces@gmail.com
610-505-0515



Get involved in making your local student wellness policy in line with the PA state model wellness plan [PSBA Local School Wellness Policy Template](#) found at:

<https://www.education.pa.gov/Teachers%20-%20Administrators/Food-Nutrition/Resources/Pages/Local-Wellness.aspx>